

INFO - AIStudio - File Guide - 2026-04-19.md

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Purpose

A guide to the files and commands that make up AIStudio — what each one does, when you'd use it, and where to find it. Written for users who want to understand what they're working with.

Commands

These are the commands available after running `./ais_install`.

Command	What it does	When to use it
<code>ais_start</code>	Starts all AIStudio services and opens the UI	Beginning of every session
<code>ais_stop</code>	Stops all AIStudio services cleanly	End of every session
<code>ais_log</code>	Shows the live backend log	Debugging; watching queries in real time
<code>ais_bench</code>	Runs the benchmark suite against a corpus	Validating retrieval quality
<code>ais_download_sec_10k</code>	Downloads SEC 10-K filings from EDGAR	Setting up the SEC corpus (optional)
<code>ais_ingest_sec_10k</code>	Ingests SEC 10-K filings into AIStudio	After downloading SEC filings

Command	What it does	When to use it
<code>ais_help</code>	Shows the command reference	When you forget a command
<code>ais_install</code>	Installs or updates AIStudio commands	Fresh install; adding a new command

The Frontend

`front_end/rag_studio.html` is the entire AIStudio user interface — a single HTML file you open directly in your browser. No server required. Everything is inline.

Key areas of the UI: - **Corpus selector** — choose which document collection to query - **Chat** — ask questions, see answers with citations - **Add / Delete** — manage documents in a corpus - **Stats** — see how many documents and chunks are indexed - **Help** — powered by AIStudio itself, answers questions about how to use it

Your Documents

Documents live in `data/corpora/<corpus-name>/uploads/`. When you delete a file from the UI, it moves to `data/corpora/<corpus-name>/trash/` — it's never permanently destroyed. Qdrant chunks are removed at delete time.

The **demo corpus** ships with AIStudio and contains 9 original documents spanning 2003–2026 — enterprise architecture, IT strategy, financial services technology, and agentic AI. Querying it is querying 20 years of original practitioner work.

Key Documentation Files

File	What it covers
<code>README.md</code>	What AIStudio is, why it was built, how it performs
<code>QUICKSTART.md</code>	How to install and run AIStudio from scratch
<code>HOWTO.md</code>	How to do specific things — corpus management, troubleshooting

File	What it covers
<code>docs/architecture_decisions.md</code>	Why key technical choices were made (Qdrant, CrossEncoder, etc.)
<code>docs/PRODUCT_ROADMAP.md</code>	What's coming in Beta, v2.0, and beyond
<code>docs/QA_TESTING_LESSONS_LEARNED.md</code>	What was discovered during fresh install testing

The System Prompt

AIStudio uses a system prompt (`prompts/system.txt`) to guide how the language model answers questions. It instructs the model to answer only from provided sources, cite every factual claim, and be direct and specific.

The corpus metadata file (`data/corpora/<name>/<name>_corpus_meta.yaml`) adds per-corpus routing guidance on top of the system prompt — telling the model which document to consult for which type of question.

Services

When AIStudio is running, four processes are active:

Service	Address	What it does
FastAPI backend	<code>localhost:8000</code>	RAG pipeline, corpus management, all API endpoints
Qdrant	<code>localhost:6333</code>	Vector store — stores and retrieves document chunks
Ollama	<code>localhost:11434</code>	Runs the language model and embedding model locally
Frontend	<code>file://</code> in browser	The UI — no server needed

How AIStudio Answers Questions

AIStudio retrieves relevant chunks from indexed documents and uses them to answer your question. It does not read files directly or display raw file content.

- **To read a specific document** — use the **Open** ↗ link in the references panel
- **To see what was retrieved** — citations show the source document and page number
- **If the answer seems incomplete** — try rephrasing or increasing Top K in settings

Version History

Version	Date	Changes
1.2.0	2026-04-19	Expanded system prompt section with actual instructions.
1.1.0	2026-04-19	Added "How AIStudio Answers Questions" section — clarifies file content retrieval behavior.
1.0.0	2026-04-19	Initial version — user-facing companion to the folder structure reference.